Zhiheng Zhang

Reliable agentic systems, cyber-physical resilience and inspectable recovery

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Concordia application/student ID: 20814667 | Doctor of Philosophy - Computer Science

International applicant; neither a Canadian citizen nor a permanent resident.

Research profile

I am interested in how autonomous software can recover from interrupted execution while preserving the user's authorization and the truth of reported outcomes. My strongest preparation is building and evaluating multi-device software systems; I would connect this experience to resilient agentic systems and, where appropriate, a bounded digital-twin setting.

Education

University of Melbourne, Australia
Master of Computer Science, 2025-present. Degree and final results pending. Master's research concerns Android privacy evidence; research supervisor: Professor Richard Sinnott.

University of British Columbia, Okanagan campus, Canada
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, awarded 2024. Undergraduate study completed in English; capstone software engineering project: 93/100.

Selected research and systems experience

Utopia / Digital-City - multi-device systems and acceptance

- Led system design, AI-assisted integration and evidence-backed acceptance of Utopia, a completed and frozen integration of my DS-Hns and Codex Boss projects.
- Bounded physical evidence covers two Windows execution workers, Android/Web control, explicit target-device routing and cross-host result/replay records. Android is a control surface, not a validated third worker.
- Maintained task/evidence links and failure histories for reproducibility. The recorded REX-990 acceptance includes 205 reconstructed runs and 243 resolved trace pointers; these are scoped historical results, not a new test run or proof of general autonomy.
- Implementation stack: JavaScript ES modules/Node.js and Kotlin/Jetpack Compose. Digital-City holds architecture, task and acceptance records; it is not a separate deployed product.

Privacy Lens - Android privacy-evidence research

- Worked on an offline, evidence-first Android research prototype and a curated reproducibility artifact. The project separates admitted observations, technical signals and obligations requiring human review.
- Relevant practice includes versioned evidence admission, reproducible metric checks and claim-to-evidence traceability. The artifact includes TypeScript/React Native/Expo and a Kotlin native layer.
- The work does not establish legal compliance, clinical outcomes, independent detection accuracy or production readiness.

Zhiheng Zhang | Research CV

Target: Jun Yan | Concordia Computer Science PhD

Earlier completed projects

- DS-Hns (completed/frozen): durable task state, restart/resume, recovery history and bounded code-task execution.
- Codex Boss (completed/frozen): multi-agent orchestration, inspectable completion evidence and acceptance governance. Both are predecessors of Utopia, not additional independent deployment claims.

Exploratory work and proposed research

- LucidGloves-derived ESP32 work: exploratory firmware and device-integration investigation, supporting an interest in embodied interaction. No validated custom glove or completed user study is claimed.
- Celestial Smart Glass: a documented research proposal for adaptive captions, session-level speaker association and user-controlled cues. No running prototype, measured hardware compatibility, participants or ethics approval is claimed.

Methods and technical practice

- Systems architecture, interface contracts and multi-device integration; designing bounded task lifecycles, state checks and recovery experiments.
- AI-assisted implementation with explicit review and acceptance; Git-based evidence/version management; test design, controlled fault injection, trace analysis and replay.
- Research emphasis: baselines and ablations, independently observable task outcomes, reproducibility and careful separation of simulation, physical observations and proposed work.

Targeted PhD direction

When an agent loses contact with an execution endpoint, what evidence is sufficient to decide whether to retry, wait, ask for authorization, or stop without duplicating an effect or accepting a false success?

Proposed starting point: Represent each consequential step with an authorization scope, state version, expected postcondition and evidence receipt.

Selected relevant coursework

Software Engineering; Capstone Software Engineering Project; Analysis of Algorithms; Research Methods.

Inspectable project evidence

Utopia - frozen implementation

REX-990 - bounded acceptance record

Privacy Lens - research artifact

Celestial Smart Glass - proposal only

Academic records accompany the email. Melbourne results are current and incomplete, not a final master's transcript. References can be arranged on request.